Singh's liberalisation was predicated on the idea that 'India cannot progress without foreign capital'. Dubashi, on the other hand, stressed that, while the BJP was not opposed to globalisation, it wanted to first build a strong 'indigenous economy that can withstand external pressures without caving in. After nearly half-a-century of mollycoddling, even organised Indian industry, let alone the rest of the economy, is no position to stand up to competitive pressures from outside.'[81] Put simply: local industry had to be defended. This is why the BJP opposed Coca Cola's takeover of Parle for $50 million (₹150 crore) which it thought was 'injurious to our economy and therefore anti-national'. Coke's annual turnover in 1993 amounted to US$ 14 billion, or ₹42,000 crore, and a profit of US$ 3 billion. In the BJP's view, Coke had paid for two-thirds of the Indian soft-drink market with less than a week's profit.[82]

These tensions came to a head during the Vajpayee regime, when the party shifted to a pro-market view. The change of registers caused a lot of disquiet in the party's traditional support base. Symptomatic of this was the RSS-affiliated Swadeshi Jagran Manch's (SJM's) opposition to the Vajpayee government's ban on the sale of non-iodised salt. In September 2000, the SJM announced a Dandi-to-Parliament 'Namak Andolan' to be organised between the birth anniversary of Pandit Deendayal Upadhyaya (25 September) and Gandhi's birth anniversary (2 October). The SJM claimed that such a ban would play into the hands of MNCs who wanted to take over the ₹1,500 crore Indian salt market. Vajpayee retreated—on 12 September, a day before the prime minister left for a US visit, the government withdrew the ban.[83]

While the SJM had made 'driving out' MNCs part of what it called a 'second freedom struggle' and raised a new war cry, 'MNCs quit India', the rollback on salt followed a major pushback within the BJP itself. The 'Quit India' theme had echoed in the BJP national executive meet on 26 August 2000. It was led by Sushma Swaraj, K.R. Malkani and Pyarelal Bharadwaj. The news magazine *India Today* noted that Vajpayee and his finance minister, Yashwant Sinha, had offered a pro-reform economic resolution at the executive meet but were thwarted. The opposing swadeshi faction in the party managed to dilute it. One example they cited was the influx of